Long Form Blog Article

Name : Angel Londhe
Portfolio Piece 03 : SEO Content Writing
Brand concept and copy

Bachat Book : First Salary blog post

The brand	A budgeting app for people in their first job. Its blog is meant to bring in search traffic from new earners, then nudge them towards the app's free 30 day tracker.
Reader	22 to 25, first salary just arrived or about to. Has heard of SIPs, hasn't started one. Doesn't want a finance lecture.
Length	1,100 to 1,300 words. Easy to read on a phone in one sitting.

Primary keyword	first salary tips
Secondary	how to manage first salary, saving money in first job, emergency fund for beginners
Meta title	First Salary Tips: How to Keep Some of It Past the 25th (55 characters)
Meta description	Your first salary feels huge for about six days. A practical, friendly guide to spending it, saving some of it and not panicking at month end. (144 characters)
URL slug	/blog/first-salary-tips

MONEY, MONTH ONE

Your First Salary Will Disappear. Here's How to Catch Some of It on the Way Out.

6 min read

The SMS arrives at 11:42 on a Tuesday morning. *Credited.* You read the number twice. You take a screenshot. You maybe send it to your mother, who replies with three folded hands emojis and a reminder to buy sweets for the neighbours.

By the 25th, you're checking your balance before ordering a ₹180 sandwich.

This happens to nearly everyone, and it isn't because you're bad with money. It's because nobody tells you that a salary isn't a pile. It's a pipe. Money comes in once and drains out all month, and unless you put a few buckets under it early, it all ends up somewhere you never chose.

These first salary tips are about placing those buckets. No complicated spreadsheets, no lecture about your coffee habit.

1. Spend some of it. Really.

Let's get this out of the way first: buy the sweets. Take your parents out for dinner. Get the shoes. Your first salary is a milestone, and trying to save every rupee of it usually backfires, because a month later you'll "reward yourself" anyway, with interest.

The trick is to decide the number *before* the money lands. Pick a figure, maybe 15 to 20 percent of this one paycheque, and call it the celebration budget. When it's gone, the party's over. That's honestly the whole trick.

2. Pay yourself before you pay Swiggy

Most people save whatever is left at the end of the month. There is never anything left at the end of the month.

Flip the order. On salary day, before you spend anything, move a fixed amount into a separate account that you don't carry a card for. Even ₹2,000 counts. Set it up as an automatic transfer so that future you doesn't get a vote.

It works because of a slightly embarrassing fact about people: we spend what we can see. Move the money out of sight and within two months you'll have adjusted to the smaller number. You won't miss it. You'll be surprised by that.

A salary isn't a pile. It's a pipe.

---

3. Build the boring fund first

Before mutual funds, before your colleague's hot tip on a stock, build an emergency fund. It's the least exciting thing on this list and easily the most important.

Aim for three to six months of basic expenses: rent, food, travel, any EMIs, the phone bill. Keep it somewhere you can reach within a day, like a savings account or a sweep in FD. Not in shares. Emergencies have a habit of showing up in the same week the market drops.

This fund is what lets you walk away from a bad job, pay a hospital bill or book a last minute ticket home without asking anyone for a loan. What it really buys you is choices, and at 23, choices are worth more than returns.

4. Find out what your company already gives you

Open your offer letter again. Somewhere in there is a list of things you already have and probably haven't read about: health insurance that sometimes covers your parents too, a provident fund deduction, meal cards, maybe a learning allowance.

Knowing this stops you from paying for the same thing twice. If your employer covers your health insurance, you'll probably still want a personal policy at some point, since the company cover ends when the job does. But you don't need to rush to buy one in month one.

While you're at it, read your payslip line by line. That PF deduction is your money, being saved on your behalf. It's nice to know it's there.

5. Track every rupee for one month

You don't need a budget yet. You need information.

For the first month, write down everything you spend. Use an app, a notes file, the back of a diary, whatever you'll actually stick with. Don't judge it and don't cut anything. Just record.

At the end of the month, sit down and look at it once. Most people find two or three surprises: a subscription they forgot about, food delivery that quietly became ₹6,000, the "just this once" cab rides that happened fourteen times. You can't fix a leak you haven't found.

6. Then, and only then, start investing

Once the emergency fund is building and you know where your money goes, start a small monthly investment. For a lot of beginners, that means a SIP in a diversified index fund, scheduled for a date just after payday.

Start smaller than feels impressive. ₹1,000 a month that you keep going for five years will do far more for you than ₹10,000 a month that you stop in March. At this stage, the habit is the asset, not the amount.

And if a friend, an uncle or someone on Instagram is very excited about a "sure thing", take that as your cue to wait a week before doing anything at all.

The creep nobody warns you about

Your second salary will feel normal. By the sixth, you'll have a new phone, a nicer flat and a lifestyle that costs exactly what you earn. Then you'll get a raise, and the same thing will happen again.

This isn't a character flaw. It's just what money does when nobody's watching it. The fix is simple: every time your income goes up, send half the increase to savings before you get used to it. You still get to enjoy the other half. Everyone wins, including the 35 year old version of you, who will be grateful and a little smug.

One last thing

You'll make mistakes. Everyone's first year with a salary includes at least one purchase they'd rather not talk about. That's fine. The goal isn't to be perfect. It's to have a few buckets under the pipe, so that when the next SMS arrives, you aren't just relieved. You're ahead.

See where your salary actually goes. Bachat Book's 30 day tracker shows you, category by category, without linking your bank account. Free to start.

This article is for general information and isn't financial advice. Think about your own situation, or speak to a SEBI registered adviser, before you invest.

> **Notes on the piece.** Every heading is an action, so someone skimming on a phone gets the whole plan from the headings alone. The keyword sits in the meta title, the URL and the intro, and nowhere it sounds forced. I used specific numbers (the ₹180 sandwich, the ₹6,000 in delivery) because they make readers recognise themselves, which a phrase like "small expenses add up" never does. The tone stays on the reader's side throughout: no shaming, because a reader who feels judged closes the tab, and a reader who closes the tab never sees the CTA.